***Board 1***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 6 3<br>♥ K Q 10 4<br>♦ K Q 8 5<br>♣ 2 | |
| ♠ 10 7 5<br>♥ J 2<br>♦ 9 6 2<br>♣ A 10 9 7 3 | | ♠ Q 4<br>♥ 8 7 6 3<br>♦ 10 7 3<br>♣ 8 6 5 4 |
| | ♠ J 9 8 2<br>♥ A 9 5<br>♦ A J 4<br>♣ K Q J | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 2♣ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♥[2] |
| Pass | 5♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

5♠ by South
Lead: ♦2

This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, NORTH uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered. This time SOUTH shows two Key Cards without the ♠Q.

Now NORTH realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

***Board 2***
North Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 7 3 2<br>♥ A K Q 8 6 4<br>♦ 5 3<br>♣ 8 7 | |
| ♠ J 9 6 5<br>♥ 10 7<br>♦ Q J 9 8<br>♣ K 10 3 | | ♠ Q 10 8<br>♥ 3 2<br>♦ 10 4 2<br>♣ Q J 9 6 2 |
| | ♠ A K 4<br>♥ J 9 5<br>♦ A K 7 6<br>♣ A 5 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♥ | Pass | 2NT |
| Pass | 3NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

3NT by South
Lead: ♦Q

The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if SOUTH decides to use RKCB it will just confuse matters when NORTH shows two Key Cards.

SOUTH has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking NORTH to further describe his hand. NORTH should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

NORTH cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so SOUTH just passes 3NT.

***Board 3***
South Deals
E-W Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K 5 3<br>♥ A 9 5 2<br>♦ 8 5 4<br>♣ 6 5 4 | |
| ♠ 9 4<br>♥ J 8 4<br>♦ 9 7 6<br>♣ K Q 9 8 2 | | ♠ 10 7<br>♥ 10 6 3<br>♦ A 10 3 2<br>♣ J 10 7 3 |
| | ♠ A Q J 8 6 2<br>♥ K Q 7<br>♦ K Q J<br>♣ A | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2♦ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♥[2] | Pass | 6♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♠9

SOUTH realizes NORTH has fewer than 8 points, but the 3♠ support bid is enough for her to try a RKCB 4NT bid.

NORTH shows two Key Cards and SOUTH figures they will be the ♠K and one of the red Aces. So she bids 6♠. If instead the Key Cards are the two red Aces SOUTH might possibly make all thirteen tricks with a finesse.

***Board 4***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A 7 2<br>♥ Q 7 4<br>♦ 9 8 5<br>♣ 9 8 4 3 | |
| ♠ 10 6 3<br>♥ 10 9 3<br>♦ A J 3 2<br>♣ J 10 2 | | ♠ 9 8 4<br>♥ J 8<br>♦ K Q 10 7 4<br>♣ 7 6 5 |
| | ♠ K Q J 5<br>♥ A K 6 5 2<br>♦ 6<br>♣ A K Q | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2♦ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♣[2] | Pass | 5♦ |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣J

NORTH's 3♥ bid is "encouraging" so SOUTH bids 4NT.

When NORTH shows one Key Card, (an Ace), SOUTH is afraid he may have a trump loser as well the other Ace. To find out about the ♥Q he bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

NORTH has the ♥Q but no King so she jumps to 6♥.

***Board 5***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A 7 2<br>♥ J 9 8 7 4<br>♦ 8 5<br>♣ 8 4 3 | |
| ♠ 9 8 3<br>♥ 10 3<br>♦ Q J 7 4<br>♣ J 10 7 6 | | ♠ 10 6 4<br>♥ Q<br>♦ A K 10 9 3 2<br>♣ 9 5 2 |
| | ♠ K Q J 5<br>♥ A K 6 5 2<br>♦ 6<br>♣ A K Q | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2♦ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♣[2] | Pass | 5♦ |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣J

This is the companion to Deal 22.

Again, worried about a possible trump loser in addition to the missing Ace, SOUTH bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

NORTH definitely does NOT have the ♥Q. But with five trumps she does know that SOUTH probably does not have a trump loser so she jumps to 6♥ anyway.

***Board 6***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 9 6 3<br>♥ A J 7 5<br>♦ K Q 2<br>♣ 6 | |
| ♠ J 7 2<br>♥ 10 8<br>♦ J 9 8 6 4<br>♣ 10 7 3 | | ♠ Q 10 4<br>♥ 3 2<br>♦ A 10 5<br>♣ Q J 9 4 2 |
| | ♠ 8 5<br>♥ K Q 9 6 4<br>♦ 7 3<br>♣ A K 8 5 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 2♠ | Pass | 3♣ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4♥ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♠[2] |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦4

NORTH cannot use RKCB at her second bid because trumps have not been agreed. So she bids 3♥ to set trumps, knowing SOUTH cannot pass after her jump-shift.

SOUTH tries to stop at game but NORTH is too strong so she now uses RKCB and gets to 6♥ when SOUTH shows two Key Cards and the trump Queen.